

Systematic Map Codebook

ILRI / Bristlepine Resilience Consultants — 2025–2026

Quick reference

Field	Valid values
confirmed_include	yes no
publication_type	journal_article report working_paper thesis other
geographic_scale	local sub-national national multi-country regional
producer_type	crop livestock fisheries_aquaculture agroforestry mixed undefined
marginalized_subpopulations	women youth people_with_disabilities landless indigenous_peoples ethnic_minorities migrant_seasonal_workers other none_reported
adaptation_focus	free text
process_outcome_domains	knowledge_awareness_learning decision_making_planning uptake_adoption behavioral_change participation_coproduction institutional_governance access_information_services yields_productivity income_assets livelihoods wellbeing risk_reduction resilience_adaptive_capacity
indicators_measured	free text
methodological_approach	qualitative quantitative participatory modeling_with_empirical_validation experimental
purpose_of_assessment	research project_learning program_evaluation donor_reporting national_reporting
data_sources	surveys administrative_data remote_sensing participatory_methods secondary_data other
temporal_coverage	cross_sectional seasonal longitudinal repeated_cross_sectional
cost_data_reported	yes no
strengths_and_limitations	free text
lessons_learned	free text

confirmed_include

Does this paper meet all five inclusion criteria?

Value	Meaning
yes	Paper meets all five criteria — proceed to fill in all 16 fields
no	Paper fails one or more criteria — leave remaining fields blank

Use the inclusion criteria below to make this decision. If you are unsure, enter your best judgement and add a note in the `notes` column.

Inclusion criteria

1. Population

Include if: Individuals or households engaged in small-scale agricultural production (crop, livestock, fisheries/aquaculture, agroforestry) in an LMIC. Also include marginalized producer groups (women, youth, landless farmers, indigenous peoples, ethnic minorities, migrant/seasonal workers).

Exclude if: Large-scale commercial agriculture, agribusiness without smallholder focus, or non-agricultural livelihoods only.

When in doubt:

Scenario	Decision
Mixed samples (smallholders + larger farms)	INCLUDE — if smallholders are mentioned and analyzed as a distinct group
Generic “Farmers” label in LMIC contexts	INCLUDE — unless study clearly focuses on commercial-scale operations
Industrial or corporate agriculture	EXCLUDE

2. Concept (Adaptation)

Include if: Study assesses or documents adaptation processes (learning, decision-making, adoption, participation, behavior change) OR adaptation outcomes (productivity, income, livelihoods, wellbeing, resilience, risk reduction).

Exclude if: - Climate impacts/vulnerability assessment ONLY (no adaptation action measured) - Mitigation only (reducing emissions) - General development or agronomy without explicit climate risk framing - Purely theoretical or conceptual (no intervention or measurement described)

When in doubt:

Scenario	Decision
Adoption/uptake of climate-smart agriculture or water management	INCLUDE
Livelihood diversification in response to climate stress	INCLUDE
Vulnerability index or risk score without coping/adaptation responses	EXCLUDE
Farmer awareness/perception of climate change alone	EXCLUDE

3. Context (Climate + Agriculture)

Include if: Agricultural setting (crop, livestock, fisheries, agroforestry) with explicit climate hazard link — drought, flooding, temperature extremes, rainfall variability, or other climate stressors affecting production.

Exclude if: - Non-agricultural sector - Agricultural study with no climate dimension - Climate mentioned only as background (not driving the research question) - Agricultural impacts/responses unrelated to climate

When in doubt:

Scenario	Decision
"Water scarcity" or "aridity" in semi-arid regions (implies climate)	INCLUDE
"Food insecurity" in LMIC rural contexts with adaptation responses	INCLUDE
Generic "livelihood change" in non-climate context	EXCLUDE
Agriculture + environmental change (without climate specificity)	EXCLUDE

4. Methodology

Include if: Study describes, evaluates, or applies a measurable method or framework to assess adaptation (indicators, metrics, surveys, qualitative interviews, participatory assessments, models with empirical data). Published 2005 or later.

Exclude if: - Purely theoretical/conceptual (no method or data) - Systematic reviews, meta-analyses, or literature reviews - Pre-2005 publication - Opinion pieces or policy briefs without empirical method

When in doubt:

Scenario	Decision
Narrative case study of farmer adaptation	INCLUDE — qualitative empirical method
Agent-based model with survey calibration	INCLUDE — model + empirical data
Pilot application of an adaptation tool	INCLUDE
Crop variety trial without farmer adoption analysis	EXCLUDE

5. Geography

Include if: Study conducted in one or more Low- or Middle-Income Countries (LMICs) or Global South countries. Single or multi-country studies OK if at least one LMIC is involved.

Exclude if: OECD high-income countries only (USA, UK, EU, Australia, Canada, Japan, South Korea, etc.) with no LMIC component.

When in doubt:

Scenario	Decision
China (all provinces)	INCLUDE — upper-middle-income
South Africa	INCLUDE — upper-middle-income
Multi-country study (e.g. Peru + Germany)	INCLUDE — Peru qualifies
Brazil, Vietnam, Thailand, Iran	INCLUDE — all are LMIC

The 16 coding fields

1. `publication_year`

Year the study was published. If multiple versions exist, use the most recent.

Valid values: integer — e.g. `2021`

Where to look: The publication year is typically listed at the very top or bottom of the pages, alongside the article's title, volume, and page numbers.

2. `publication_type`

Value	Meaning
<code>journal_article</code>	Peer-reviewed journal
<code>report</code>	Project/programme report, evaluation report, policy brief
<code>working_paper</code>	Pre-publication working paper or discussion paper
<code>thesis</code>	PhD or master's dissertation
<code>other</code>	Book chapter, conference paper, dataset paper

Where to look:

- **Headers, Footers, and Margins:** Check the very top or bottom of pages for journal name, volume, issue, and page numbers—these immediately identify peer-reviewed journal articles.
- **Cover Pages (Grey Literature):** Non-peer-reviewed reports often feature a standalone cover page with the logos and names of publishing organizations (NGOs, World Bank, FAO, research institutes, government ministries).
- **Disclaimers and Acknowledgements:** Look at footnotes on the first page or inside covers. Working papers and discussion papers often include explicit disclaimers stating the research is preliminary, circulating for discussion, or lacks formal peer review.
- **Degree Requirements (Theses/Dissertations):** The title page will typically include text stating "A thesis/dissertation submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of [Master's/PhD]..." followed by the university name.

3. `country_region`

Country or countries where the study was conducted. Use a region label only if no countries are named.

Format: free text; separate multiple entries with semicolons

Examples: `Tanzania` | `Ghana`; `Mali`; `Burkina Faso` | `East Africa` | `Global`

Where to look: Scan the **article's title, abstract, introduction, and Methods / Study Area description**—authors typically state the study location early and clearly.

4. geographic_scale

Value	Meaning
local	Village, community, single site
sub-national	District, province, region within a country
national	One country
multi-country	Two or more specific named countries
regional	Broad region without country-level focus

Where to look: Check the **Methods / Study Area / Site Description** section—this is the most definitive place. Authors must clearly state whether their study focused on a single village, a district within a country, the entire country, multiple named countries, or a broad geographic region.

5. producer_type

Select all that apply; separate with semicolons.

Value	Meaning
crop	Crop farming systems
livestock	Livestock farming systems
fisheries_aquaculture	Fisheries or aquaculture systems
agroforestry	Agroforestry systems
mixed	Explicitly mixed crop-livestock
undefined	Generic “smallholder farmers” with no production system specified

Where to look: Look in the Abstract and Introduction: Authors usually state their target population and main agricultural focus right away. If not, check the Methods / Study Area / Site Description sections: This is the most reliable place to look, as authors must describe the economic and agricultural baselines of the communities they are surveying.

6. marginalized_subpopulations

Code only what is **explicitly stated** in the paper — do not infer. Select all that apply; separate with semicolons.

Value	Meaning
women	Women explicitly targeted or gender-disaggregated analysis
youth	Young farmers or age-disaggregated outcomes
people_with_disabilities	Persons with disabilities explicitly named
landless	Landless households or tenure-insecure groups
indigenous_peoples	Indigenous communities named
ethnic_minorities	Ethnic minority groups named
migrant_seasonal_workers	Migrant or seasonal agricultural workers
other	Any other marginalised group explicitly named — add a note in <code>notes</code>
none_reported	No marginalised groups mentioned

Where to look:

- **Abstract and Introduction:** Authors often state upfront if their study specifically targets or evaluates a vulnerable subgroup.
- **Methods / Sampling / Study Area sections:** This section details exactly who was surveyed and how they were chosen. Look for descriptions of “purposive sampling” criteria—e.g., “deliberately selecting participants based on gender (if known) and/or youth.”
- **Results and Descriptive Statistics (Tables):** Check baseline household characteristics tables and demographic summaries to identify which groups were explicitly studied.
- **Discussion and Conclusion:** Authors often highlight how interventions impact marginalized groups differently—e.g., “inherent resource inequities between men and women constrain adaptation.”

7. `adaptation_focus` (free text)

The specific climate adaptation action, intervention, or practice the study tracks. Write 5–15 words based on what the paper describes.

Examples: - `crop varieties and genetics` - `water management and irrigation` - `climate information and advisory services` - `livelihood diversification (non-farm)` - `agroforestry` - `livestock management` - `financial strategies` - `social and community networking`

Where to look:

- **Abstract and Introduction:** Authors usually highlight the primary interventions or adaptation strategies they are investigating right away.
- **Methods / Interventions / Study Design sections:** This is where authors detail the specific strategies tested, promoted, or surveyed in the study.
- **Results and Descriptive Statistics (Tables):** Look for tables detailing adoption rates, summary statistics, or regression variables—these list the exact practices tracked.
- **Discussion and Conclusion:** If the study is a modeling or vulnerability assessment that doesn’t test a specific intervention, authors will often propose an adaptation focus in these sections.
- **Appendix / Survey Instrument:** If the researchers include their questionnaire, it will show the exact adaptation options they asked farmers about.

Example: In the Malawi study, the “Sampling methods and agroecological experiments” section provides a categorized list of the exact methods farmers selected: integration of trees, soil fertility methods, crop diversification, and livelihood diversification (e.g., small livestock).

8. `process_outcome_domains`

What the study measures. Select all that apply; separate with semicolons.

Rule: Code only domains that are **explicitly measured** — not domains that could be inferred. If the paper measures yield but not income, code `yields_productivity` only.

Value	Meaning
knowledge_awareness_learning	Awareness of climate change, knowledge of options, learning outcomes
decision_making_planning	Farmer decision-making, use of forecasts in planning
uptake_adoption	Rates of adoption of a practice or technology
behavioral_change	Changes in farming or land management behaviour
participation_coproduction	Participation in programmes, co-design, farmer group engagement
institutional_governance	Policy uptake, institutional change, governance
access_information_services	Access to extension, credit, markets, climate information
yields_productivity	Crop yield, livestock productivity, fish catch
income_assets	Household income, asset accumulation
livelihoods	Food security, livelihood diversification
wellbeing	Health, nutrition, subjective wellbeing
risk_reduction	Reduced exposure or sensitivity to climate shocks
resilience_adaptive_capacity	Adaptive capacity indices, resilience scores, vulnerability indices

Where to look:

- **Methods / Variable Descriptions / Summary Statistics (Tables):** Authors will list the specific process indicators they tracked in these sections.
- **Results / Findings sections:** Qualitative and quantitative changes in knowledge, learning, and participation are reported here.
- **Discussion and Conclusion:** Authors often interpret how an intervention affected social processes, learning, or institutional dynamics in these sections.

Example: In the Central Vietnam study, the results section explicitly reports on farmers' "capacity to learn," "capacity to decide," and "capacity to act" in a dedicated results subsection.

9. indicators_measured (free text)

The specific indicators or metrics used. Extract from the methods or results sections. Include units where stated.

Examples: - yield (t/ha), income (USD/season), food security score (HFIAS) - adoption rate (%), area under improved variety (ha) - climate resilience index score

Where to look:

- **Tables (Variable Descriptions and Summary Statistics):** Authors almost always consolidate their indicators into comprehensive tables for clarity.
- **Methodology / Data Collection / Variables sections:** The narrative text in these sections describes the specific tools, scales, or census data used to capture the indicators.
- **Appendix / Survey Instrument:** If you need to see the exact questions asked to construct an indicator, the appendix is the most reliable place. For example, the Northern Ghana study includes "Appendix B: Survey questionnaire with indicators scoring criterion," which shows the precise multiple-choice questions used and how points were assigned to measure economic resources, social capital, and technology.

10. methodological_approach

Select all that apply; separate with semicolons.

Value	Meaning
qualitative	Qualitative research design (interviews, focus groups, ethnography)
quantitative	Quantitative research design (surveys, statistical analysis)
participatory	Only when participation is the primary design (PRA, photovoice) — not when farmers are merely surveyed
modeling_with_empirical_validation	Crop/climate/agent-based models validated with field data
experimental	RCTs, natural experiments, quasi-experimental approaches

Where to look:

- **Methods / Methodology / Materials and Methods section:** Authors typically dedicate this entire section to explaining their research design, often breaking it down into specific subsections.
- **Data Collection / Sampling subsections:** Here, authors detail whether they used surveys, expert interviews, focus groups, or secondary data.
- **Data Analysis / Empirical Approach subsection:** This subsection explains the statistical or qualitative frameworks used to evaluate the data.
- **Abstract:** Authors almost always provide a concise, one-to-two-sentence summary of their methods right at the beginning of the paper.
- **Introduction (final paragraphs):** Right after stating their research objectives at the end of the introduction, authors frequently include a brief preview of their methodology.

Example: The Malawi study introduces its methodology by stating: "A participatory research approach combined with pre-post longitudinal study design was used to examine changes..."

11. purpose_of_assessment

Value	Meaning
research	Academic study with no programme affiliation
project_learning	M&E embedded in an ongoing project
program_evaluation	Formal evaluation of a completed programme
donor_reporting	Report produced for a donor or funder
national_reporting	Contributing to NAPs, NDCs, or national monitoring frameworks

Where to look:

- **Abstract:** Authors typically provide a high-level summary of why the study was conducted right at the beginning of the document.
- **Introduction (end of section):** Standard academic writing conventions dictate that authors explicitly outline their goals, objectives, or research questions at the very end of the introduction section, right before diving into the methodology. **Example:** "The specific research objective of this study is to test whether agroecological farming methods... can improve food security..."

- **Conclusion / Summary:** Authors often briefly restate the core purpose of their assessment in the concluding section when summarising what their study ultimately set out to achieve and what it found.

12. data_sources

Select all that apply; separate with semicolons.

Value	Meaning
surveys	Primary household or farm surveys
administrative_data	Government or programme records
remote_sensing	Satellite or aerial imagery
participatory_methods	PRA, focus groups, photovoice as a data source
secondary_data	Existing datasets, literature, or other secondary sources
other	Any data source not listed above

Where to look:

- **Methods / Methodology / Materials and Methods section:** This is the primary and most detailed location. Authors almost always include specific subsections dedicated to explaining where their data came from. **Example:** In the Northern Ghana study, the “Data collection” subsection under “Research methods” explicitly outlines the use of primary data (expert interviews and structured questionnaires) and secondary data (a systematic literature review).
- **Data / Data and Variables sections:** Sometimes, authors dedicate a top-level section specifically to the data used, especially in economic or quantitative studies relying heavily on existing secondary datasets or household panels. **Example:** The East Africa study features a section titled “Data, description of variables, and summary statistics,” which explains that their data came from a baseline household survey collected by the CGIAR Research Program on Climate Change, Agriculture, and Food Security (CCAFS).

13. temporal_coverage

Value	Meaning
cross_sectional	Single point in time or single season
seasonal	Intra-annual, across one or a few seasons
longitudinal	Multi-year, panel data, repeated measures with the same individuals
repeated_cross_sectional	Multi-year, repeated measures with different individuals each time

Where to look:

- **Abstract:** Authors frequently summarize the study's timeframe or experimental design right at the beginning. **Example:** The Malawi study abstract explicitly mentions a “four-year study,” baseline and follow-up surveys conducted in 2011 and 2013, and the use of “Longitudinal mixed effects models.”
- **Methodology / Data Collection / Study Design sections:** This is the most definitive place to find temporal coverage—authors must detail exactly when and how often they collected their data.

- **Data and Variables / Climate Modeling sections:** If the study relies on secondary data, historical records, or predictive modeling (rather than field surveys), these sections will define the exact time periods analyzed.

14. `cost_data_reported`

Value	Meaning
<code>yes</code>	Paper explicitly reports cost figures or cost-effectiveness ratios
<code>no</code>	No cost data — a qualitative mention of “limited resources” counts as <code>no</code>

Where to look:

- **Results / Economic Evaluation sections:** If the core purpose of the study involves an economic or financial assessment, the exact cost figures, cost-benefit analyses, or cost-effectiveness ratios will be reported in the results, usually accompanied by data tables.
- **Discussion and Conclusion:** Authors may summarize the exact financial requirements for implementing an adaptation strategy at a regional scale, or they may compare its cost-effectiveness against other measures.

Quick-search tip: Use your document viewer’s search function to scan for currency symbols or acronyms (e.g., \$, USD, VND, Euro) and economic keywords like “cost-effectiveness,” “CBA” (cost-benefit analysis), “expenditure,” or “budget.”

15. `strengths_and_limitations` *(free text)*

Author-reported strengths and limitations. Look in the Discussion, Conclusion, and Limitations sections. Extract verbatim where possible.

Format: `Strength: <text>. Limitation: <text>.`

Where to look:

- **Discussion Section:** This is the most common place to find both strengths and limitations. As authors interpret their findings, they typically reflect on the robustness of their study design, highlight how their research makes strong contributions to existing literature, and acknowledge any methodological, sample size, or data constraints.
- **Conclusion:** Authors often briefly summarize the main strengths (e.g., “This study provides novel insights into...”) and note any boundaries to their findings, frequently tying these limitations directly to recommendations for future research.
- **Dedicated “Limitations” subsection:** Some journals require authors to include a specific subsection—usually at the very end of the Discussion—explicitly detailing the study’s constraints.

16. `lessons_learned` *(free text)*

Key lessons or recommendations the authors report. 1–3 sentences. Focus on what they say should be done differently — not the findings themselves. Enter `not_reported` if absent.

Where to look: Look at the Discussion section: This is the primary area where authors interpret their results, explain why certain interventions worked or failed, and extract practical insights. The Conclusion (or specific “Implications” and “Recommendations” subsections): Authors consistently use the final sections of the paper to synthesise their overarching lessons for policymakers, donors, or future researchers. The Abstract (Final Sentences): Authors frequently distill their most critical lesson learned into the final lines of the abstract.

Questions: zarrar@bristlep.com